

MAINS MASTER PROGRAM (MMP) 2024
INDIAN SOCIETY – 3
DIVERSITY

- **Concept of Diversity:** Collective differences which mark off one group as different from another
- **Manifestation of diversity:** Linguistic, Religious, Regional, Racial.

Linguistic Diversity:

- India, which is home to about 6% of global population with nearly 2.4% of the world's land surface, has nurtured more than **19,500 languages** or dialects, which are spoken in India as **mother tongues**.
- India is extremely linguistically diverse and is often known for "**Kos Kos par Badle Paani, char Kos par Vaani**".
- Language is the most powerful instrument of **cultural identity** and has always remained a **source of both cohesion and conflict**.
- Often discourse has emerged due to **feelings of relative deprivation and fear of domination** by the majority of language speakers.
- In post-independence, there were 2 major issues: **Linguistic reorganisation of states and Official Language Issue**.
- Decisions regarding official language and territorial boundaries can have profound implications for governance, social cohesion, and the preservation of cultural heritage.
- Navigating this complex terrain requires a delicate balance between acknowledging linguistic diversity and promoting national unity, while also addressing the aspirations and rights of linguistic minorities.

Linguistic organization of states:

- The topic stands at intersection of politics, culture, and identity wielding significant influence over the fabric of a nation.
- Language, as a vehicle of communication and expression, holds immense power in shaping societal dynamics and fostering a sense of belonging among its speaker
- The linguistic reorganization of states in India was a significant political development aimed at creating states based on linguistic lines, which means that the boundaries of the states were defined to align with the predominant language spoken by the population in that region. This reorganization was a response to the diverse linguistic diversity in India and aimed to ensure better governance and administration based on linguistic and cultural affinity. (Strengthening of democracy, education in mother tongue)
- Issue was the time and conditions prevailing then: Partition, integration of princely states, large scale migration)

Varied viewpoints related to the linguistic reorganization of states:

- **Congress Party's Commitment:** The idea of linguistic states gained momentum in India after the Indian National Congress committed to it in 1917. The party's Nagpur Session in 1920 formalized this commitment, and provincial Congress committees were organized along linguistic lines.
- **Gandhiji's Support:** Mahatma Gandhi supported the concept of linguistic states, considering it a means of fostering better understanding and unity among people through the use of their native languages.
- **Nehruji's Apprehension:** After the traumatic partition of India based on religious lines in 1947, Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru was initially cautious about further dividing the country on linguistic grounds. However, demands for linguistic states gained momentum in the post-independence period.

Justice S.K. Dhar Commission (1948):

- The Justice S.K. Dhar Commission, appointed by the Constituent Assembly in 1948, was tasked with enquiring into the desirability of linguistic provinces in India.
- It was established in response to growing demands from various linguistic communities for states based on language.
- Recommendations: The Dhar Commission, in its report submitted in December 1948, recommended against the creation of linguistic provinces. Instead, it suggested reorganizing states based on administrative convenience rather than linguistic factors.
- This recommendation created dissatisfaction among those who were advocating for linguistic states.

JVP Committee (1949):

- The JVP Committee, consisting of Jawaharlal Nehru, Sardar Patel, and Pattabhi Sitaramayya, was established in 1949 to re-evaluate the issue of linguistic provinces in India.
- JVP Committee rejected language as the basis for reorganizing states. It did not support the idea of linguistic provinces.
- The recommendations of these committees and commissions reflected the complexities and challenges associated with the linguistic reorganization of states in India.
- Ultimately, the demand for linguistic states continued to grow, leading to further discussions and actions on this issue in subsequent years.

Andhra Pradesh – First State based on Linguistic Reorganisation:

- After India gained independence, there was a widespread movement across the country advocating for states to be organized on linguistic lines. This movement was characterized by various methods including petitions, representations, street marches, and protests.

- **T. Prakasam:** Former Chief Minister of Madras, T. Prakasam, resigned from the Congress party in 1950 to support the cause of linguistic states.
- **Swami Sitaram:** Another prominent figure in this movement, Swami Sitaram, went on a hunger strike to support the demand for a separate Andhra state. His hunger strike ended after an appeal from veteran Gandhian leader Vinoba Bhave.
- **Potti Sriramulu's Fast unto Death:** On October 19, 1952, Potti Sriramulu, a popular freedom fighter, began a fast unto death to demand a separate Andhra state. Tragically, he passed away after fasting for fifty-eight days. This event sparked widespread agitation, including rioting, demonstrations, and violence across Andhra.
- **Formation of Andhra State:** In response to the intensifying agitation and the sacrifice of Potti Sriramulu, Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru announced the formation of a separate Andhra State in December 1952.
- **Creation of Andhra State (1953):** In October 1953, the Government of India took the significant step of creating the first linguistic state, known as Andhra State. This involved the separation of Telugu-speaking areas from the Madras State. The creation of Andhra state set a precedent for the formation of states based on linguistic affinity, a principle that shaped the map of India.

Fazl Ali Commission (1953) and State Reorganisation Act, 1956

Formation of the Commission:

- In response to the demands for linguistic states following the creation of Andhra State, Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru appointed the States Reorganisation Commission (SRC) in August 1953. Justice Fazl Ali served as the Chairman of the commission, with K.M. Panikkar and Hridaynath Kunzru as its members.
- The Commission accepted language as the basis for the reorganisation of states. However, it rejected the theory of 'One-Language-One-State'.
- It emphasized that the unity of India should be considered the primary consideration in any redrawing of the country's political units.

State Reorganisation Act, 1956:

- The recommendations of the Fazl Ali Committee culminated in the enactment of the State Reorganisation Act in November 1956.
- This act led to the creation of fourteen states and six centrally administered territories.

Aftermath of State Reorganization Act 1956:

Maharashtra-Gujarat Division:

- The recommendation of the SRC and the subsequent State Reorganisation Act led to significant opposition in Maharashtra. Riots and protests erupted in 1956.

- The government, in response to the pressure, decided to divide the Bombay state into two linguistic states: Maharashtra and Gujarat. Bombay city was to form a separate, centrally administered state.

Resentment and Opposition:

- The division plan faced strong opposition, especially from Maharashtrians who were dissatisfied with the proposed arrangement.
- The people of Gujarat were also apprehensive as they felt they would be a minority in the new state. They were unwilling to give up Bombay city to Maharashtra.

Escalation of Unrest:

- The disagreement over the status of Bombay city intensified the agitation. Violence and arson spread to Ahmedabad and other parts of Gujarat.
- Despite the protests and disagreements, the government passed the States Reorganisation Act in November 1956. This formalized the division of states.
- Popular agitation persisted for nearly five years as people in Maharashtra and Gujarat continued to voice their discontent.
- In May 1960, after years of protests and negotiations, the government agreed to bifurcate the state of Bombay into Maharashtra and Gujarat.
- As per the resolution, Bombay city was included in Maharashtra, and Ahmedabad was designated as the capital of Gujarat.
- The division of the Bombay state into Maharashtra and Gujarat marked a significant chapter in India's linguistic reorganisation process, demonstrating the complexities and sensitivities involved in accommodating regional and linguistic identities.

Punjab: Exception to Linguistic Principle:

- Punjab was an exception to the linguistic reorganisation principle. Even after the merger of PEPSU (Patiala and East Punjab States Union) with Punjab in 1956, the state remained trilingual, with speakers of Punjabi, Hindi, and Pahari.
- **Demand for Punjabi Suba:** In the Punjabi-speaking regions, there was a strong demand for the creation of a separate Punjabi Suba (Punjabi-speaking state).
- **Communal Overtones:** The issue took on communal dimensions, further complicating the matter.
- **Division of Punjab:** In 1966, under the leadership of Prime Minister Indira Gandhi, it was decided to divide Punjab into two states: Punjab (Punjabi-speaking) and Haryana (Hindi-speaking). The Pahari-speaking district of Kangra and a part of Hoshiarpur were merged with Himachal Pradesh. Chandigarh, the newly constructed city and capital of united Punjab, was designated as a Union Territory and was intended to serve as the joint capital for both Punjab and Haryana.

Achievements of Linguistic Reorganisation:

- The linguistic reorganisation process allowed for **greater political participation** by the people.
- It demonstrated that **language loyalty can be complementary to national loyalty**.
- The reorganisation **addressed a significant grievance** that could have led to divisive tendencies.
- It did not weaken the federal structure or the unity of the nation. Instead, it **rationalised the political map without undermining national unity**.
- It removed a major source of discord, creating **more homogenous political units** that could be administered using a language understood by the majority.
- Ultimately, linguistic reorganisation **proved to be a unifying and integrating force** rather than a divisive one.
- Relieved people from feeling of relative deprivation
- Gave people a sense of security wrt culture and livelihood
- Fulfilment of political administration and economic aspiration
- Strengthened Democracy

Issues due to linguistic reorganisation of states:

- Can lead to linguistic nationalism.
- **Spillover effect:** It was like opening **pandora's box** as India is a land of multiple linguistic cultures so even after linguistic reorganization, the demand for the state continues to persist. **Eg: Gorkhaland** (it was precipitated when it was declared that Bengali can be declared as sole official language in W. Bengal), **Mithilanchal, Bhojpur, etc.**
- The **basis** for the **creation of small states** was **spilled** over into other areas such as river water disputes, underdevelopment, administrative convenience, etc.
- It can **lead to regionalism** and may have of in groupism and bandwagon effect.

Rajani Kothari said, "linguistic reorganization was functional as it removed the major source of discord and created homogeneous political units which could be administered through a medium (language) that vast majority understood.

Q) "Discuss to what extent linguistic reorganization of state has contributed to Indian unity? Discuss" 2016. 10 marks.

Official Language Act:

Background:

- The language issue emerged as one of the **most contentious and divisive matters** in the initial two decades following India's independence.

- The **idea of one national language** for an Indian national identity had already been overwhelmingly **rejected by the majority of the national leadership**, which upheld secular principles. India was a **multilingual nation**, and it needed to remain so. The Indian national movement had conducted its ideological and political work through various regional languages. At that time, the demand was to replace English with the mother tongue as the medium for higher education, administration, and courts in each linguistic area.

Course of Official Language:

- The resolution of the national language issue came about when the framers of the Constitution essentially acknowledged **all major languages as 'languages of India'** or India's national languages.
- However, this wasn't the end of the matter. It **was not practical for the country's** official work to be conducted in so many languages. There needed to be a common language through which the central government could conduct its operations and maintain communication with the state governments.
- **English** was sought/considered by some as a **strong contender**: Language of international diplomacy, Trade, and Commerce, Exposure to western thought, and A broad spectrum of academic work was available in the language.
- However according to **Mahatma Gandhi**, "**English will never be accepted as the official language due to unequal relations with Britishers**".
- The conflict over the official language of the Indian union was a central issue. It particularly flared up in **opposition to Hindi**, leading to **tensions between Hindi-speaking and non-Hindi-speaking regions**. The **question of the time-frame for** transitioning from English to Hindi created a divide between Hindi-speaking and non-Hindi-speaking regions. Advocates for Hindi wanted an immediate switch, while those from non-Hindi areas pushed for the retention of English for a prolonged, if not an indefinite period.

Constitution and Laws of Parliament:

- The Constitution stipulated that Hindi, written in the Devanagari script and with international numerals, would be designated as India's official language.
- Under **article 343**, **Hindi in Devanagari script** was adopted the **official language** and **English** will be the **associate official language till 1965**. English was slated to continue for all official purposes until 1965, after which it would be replaced by Hindi. The introduction of Hindi was to be done in stages. Post-1965, it would become the sole official language. Nevertheless, **Parliament retained the authority** to allow the use of English for specified purposes even after 1965.
- The **Constitution placed the onus on the government to foster the spread and advancement of Hindi**. It also provided for the establishment of a Commission and a Joint Committee of the Parliament to monitor progress in this regard. **At the state**

level, the decision regarding the official language would be determined by the state legislatures. However, the **official language of the Union would serve as the means of communication between the states and the Centre, as well as between one state and another**

- **1960:** In April 1960, the **President issued an order** stating that **after 1965**, Hindi would be the **principal official language**, while **English would continue as the associate official language** without any restrictions. To promote Hindi, the **central government, in accordance with the President's directive**, took a series of measures, including establishing the Central Hindi Directorate, publishing important works in Hindi or in Hindi translation in various fields, mandating training of central government employees in Hindi, translating major legal texts into Hindi, and promoting their use in the courts.
- **1963: The Official Languages Act was enacted.** The objective of this Act was to **remove the restriction** placed by the constitution on the use of English after a specified date, namely 1965. The **Act faced criticism due to the ambiguity arising from the use of the word "may" instead of "shall"**.
- **Change in stance:** Non-Hindi leaders, in protest, altered their approach to the official language issue. **Initially**, they had **demanding a slowdown** in the replacement of English, but they shifted their stance to **advocate against setting a deadline** for the transition.
- Tamil Nadu saw significant protests, some even resorting to self-immolation. Tragically, around 60 people lost their lives due to police firing during the agitation. Later, when Indira Gandhi assumed the role of Prime Minister in 1966, she introduced an amendment to the 1963 Official Languages Act in 1967.
- **1967:** Official Language Amendment Act was passed which ensured an **indefinite policy of bilingualism**. It established **English as an associate language**, in addition to Hindi, for official work at the central level. Moreover, **communication** between the central government and non-Hindi states **would continue in English for as long as non-Hindi states deemed it necessary**. This amendment effectively adopted an indefinite policy of bilingualism. The states were encouraged to implement a **three-language formula**. This involved the study of a modern Indian language, preferably one from the Southern languages, in addition to Hindi and English in Hindi-speaking areas. In non-Hindi speaking areas, the formula included the study of Hindi along with the regional languages and English. Furthermore, the Parliament adopted a policy resolution dictating that **public service exams were to be conducted in Hindi and English, as well as in all regional languages**. It was stipulated that candidates must have additional proficiency in either Hindi or English.
- **Post-1967**, the problem has gradually disappeared from the political scene demonstrating the capacity of the Indian political system to deal with the problem on a democratic basis and in a manner to promote national consolidation.

Q) Implementation of the language provision proved to be a formidable task in the initial decades after independence. (10 marks/150 words)

Regional Diversity and Regionalism

Concept of Region and regionalism-

- Region: Homogeneous area which is physically and culturally distinct from the neighbouring area. People living in the region have sufficient awareness that they are similar but distinct from others. This leads to development of regional identity
- Overtime, People start professing their political loyalties more towards the region rather than the state/country which it is part of.
- Regionalism is rooted in India's diversity wrt caste, religion, language, ethnicity, etc. When all these factors gets geographically concentrated along with the feeling of relative deprivation, it is referred as regionalism
- It is important to note that local patriotism and loyalty to one's locality, region, or state and its language and culture do not necessarily constitute regionalism
- However, regionalism can become problematic when the interests of one region or state are asserted against the country as a whole or against another region or state in a hostile manner.
- In the context of India, regionalism has been one of the biggest challenges for the consolidation of the country as a nation since its independence.

Characteristics of regionalism

- It is, at times, a **psychological phenomenon**. For example, India and Pakistan were divided to solve problems that were perceived and feared, rather than being actually present.
- It is built around an **expression of group identity as well as loyalty towards the region**. For example, the tribals in Jharkhand-Chhattisgarh area consider their land to be sacred, and trace their identity to a common ancestor of the region. They do not tolerate outside interference, especially since outsiders do not understand their ways and customs. Such outsiders may even consist of non-tribals belonging to the same state. It **presupposes the concept of development of one's own region** without taking into consideration the interest of other regions. The recurrent and ever ongoing river water disputes between states and nations could be traced to such factors.
- Regionalism, at times, **prohibits people from other regions to be benefited by a particular region**. The demand for a 'Marathwada' (Maharashtra for Marathwadis) is a case in point here.

Types of Regionalism

1. Secessionist Demands
2. Supra-state Regionalism
3. Inter-state Regionalism
4. Intra-state Regional Politics or Sub-regionalism.

Secessionist Demands

- Regional politics manifested in the form of people in certain states or regions demanding to secede from the Indian Union and become independent sovereign states. Such demands occurred soon after independence and are largely non-existent now.
- The important examples in this context are that of the Plebiscite Front (Kashmir), Mizo National Front (Lushei Hills of Assam), Nagaland Socialist Conference (Naga Hills District of Assam), Khalistan etc.

Supra-state Regionalism

- It's when certain states express their group identity by coming together to support shared interests. This identity is related to particular issues.
- Eg: DravidaNadu demand prior to the re-organisation of the states, 1956.
- Eg: Similarly, the grouping of the North Eastern States for greater access to economic development is another instance.
- Eg: **North Indian states vs South Indian states** on the issue of official Language.

Inter-state Regionalism

- It is related to state boundaries and involves overlapping of one or more state identities, which threaten their interests.
- Inter state river water disputes, Border Issues, Dispute between Punjab and Haryana over Chandigarh, Dispute between Maharashtra Karnataka over Belgaum.

Intra-state Regional Politics or Sub-regionalism

- This refers to regionalism, which exists within a state of the Indian Union. It embodies the desire of a part of a state for identity and self-development. It may also reflect a notion of deprivation or exploitation of a part of the state at the expense of another. This type of regionalism can be found in many parts of India.
- Eg: Vidarbha in Maharashtra, Saurashtra in Gujarat, East U.P. in Uttar Pradesh, Bodoland (Ethnic Issue), Gorkha land (Language Issue)

Basis of regionalism

- **Historical**: It supported regionalism on the basis of culture, folklore myths, etc. For ex: demand for Dravidanadu was supported by the theory that Dravidian-speaking areas

once had non-Brahminical polity which was destroyed by Aryan conquests and hegemony.

- **Geographical**: Presence of natural resources, landforms, international borders, connectivity, climate, rainfall, buffer area, etc. Example: Northeast: Presence of Chicken neck, 99% of its borders are international. Northeast: Golden Triangle
- **Socio-cultural**: Language has been a most important mark of group identification hence giving rise to **linguistic regionalism**. Example: Bifurcation of Greater Assam. Although there have been some demands based on caste and religion, for example, in the context of Tamilnadu, and Punjab respectively, however, since these demands were considered a threat to the secular fabric of India they were presented in the garb of linguistic demands
- **Politico-Administrative**: **Politics do not create regionalism, it accentuates regionalism**. It takes advantage of the situation of regional discontent and converts it in their favour so as to strengthen their vote bank. Lack of proper implementation of Land Reforms. Other important facets of the politics of regionalism are the real or assumed charges of political discrimination among various regions by the central ruling elite.
- **Economic**: It is the crux of regional politics. It is based on the fact that resources are limited and demands are disproportionate. The govt. policies since independence have failed to address regional disparities and instead aggravated the regional inequality and economic differences. Due to the unequal distribution of development benefits, there has been a demand for smaller states. (INTER COLONIALISM) Example: Despite being rich in natural resources some regions remain underdeveloped like North East. Telangana did accuse Andhra of colonizing their region, by grabbing their jobs, land, and govt not investing in their infrastructure, opportunities, etc., Green Revolution: Western UP v/s Eastern UP,

Impact of Regionalism-

- It plays an **important role in nation-building** if it accommodates federal sentiments.
- By accepting the demand it gives the **right of self-determination** to the people
- Not always the regional interest pitted against national interest, in fact, sometimes it ensures **better integration of people in overall governance**. For eg: If we intend to **concretize our own identity** (Linguistic reorganization of states). If for **purpose of socio-economic development** (Telangana, Jharkhand, Chattisgarh). If for **administrative convenience** (Uttarakhand)
- It helps in **keeping political extremism** at bay
- It helps in **realizing the salad bowl theory of multiculturalism** in the true sense.

However,

- It can be seen as a **threat** to overall development and unity especially when it has **violent overtones**

- It acts as a source of **internal security challenges**
- It has become a tool in **hands of politicians to serve their vested** interest (Vote bank politics)
- It may also **hinder international diplomacy (Role of India in Srilankan civil war)**
- **Unequal distribution of resources** due to the presence of strong regional leaders also leads to relative deprivation.
- Sometimes when it has **secessionist tendencies** it threatens the territorial integrity.
- **Son of soil**-State constitutes the **exclusive homeland of its main language speakers** or local residents. Example: Karnataka, Maharashtra, Haryana, Assam.

Son of Soil:

- Sons of Soil Doctrine underlies the view that a state specifically belongs to the main linguistic group inhabiting it or that the **state constitutes the exclusive 'homeland' of its main language speakers who are the 'sons of the soil' or the 'local residents'**
- All others who live there or are settled there and whose mother tongue is not the state's main language are declared 'outsiders'. These outsiders might have lived in the state for a long time, or have migrated there more recently, but they are not regarded as the 'sons of the soil'.
- Eg:- Campaign for safeguard of interests of Maharashtrians.
- Eg: Clashes among Bodos and Bengalis in Assam
- A sons-of-the-soil (SoS) conflict has the following core features:
 1. First, it involves conflict between members of a ethnic group concentrated in some region of a country, and relatively recent, ethnically distinct migrants to this region from other parts of the same country.
 2. Second, the members of the ethnic group think of their group as indigenous, and as rightfully possessing the area as their group's ancestral (or at least very long-standing) home.
 3. By "conflict" we mean competition and dispute over scarce resources such as land, jobs, educational quotas, government services, or natural resources. A SoS conflict may be violent, but it need not be.
- **Factors responsible for Son of soil:** Lack of culture of out-migration, clash for middle class jobs, presence of strong regional parties, Failure of the state to accommodate the interest of both natives and migrants, Due to rising aspirations anything short of expectations is met with resentment.

Balancing Regionalism and Nationalism:

- **Cooperative Federalism:** Practicing cooperative federalism involves collaboration between regions and the national government to achieve common goals.
- **Conflict Resolution Mechanisms:** Effective mechanisms for resolving regional conflicts are necessary to ensure national unity in the face of regional tensions.

- **Devolution of Power:** Devolving power to regions while safeguarding critical national interests allows for regional autonomy within a unified framework.
- **Inclusive Policies:** Policies should be inclusive, recognizing both regional disparities and the overarching national agenda.
- **Public Awareness:** Promoting awareness about the importance of this balance is vital for fostering a shared commitment to the nation's well-being.

Racial Intolerance:

The concept of Race is defined as a social group consisting of people having distinct physical traits, for eg. skin color, facial features, etc.

Causes of Racial Intolerance

- Lack of Cultural integrity
- Stereotyping - Prejudices
- Obsession with fair complexion
- Discrepancy between demand and supply/availability of resources
- Anti-Social elements which pit one group against another using a zero-sum game theory of power
- Racially biased attitude among some officials
- Cultural Chauvinism
- Stereotype is further enforced through cultural platform eg. media, cinema, etc.
- Lack of deterrence (poor conviction rate, judicial delays)

Implication:

- **At the Individual Level** - lack of life with dignity, limited access to resources, lack of availability of opportunities for social mobility, self-alienation, radicalization, lack of confidence, insecurity, and feeling of relative deprivation lead to an increase in crime.
- **At the societal Level** - High potential for social conflict, and a lack of development of social capital, threatening the prospects of unity and diversity
- **At National Level** - hampers bilateral relations, Threatens the prospects of India to emerge as an education tourism hub, and global power negatively impacts the potential of demographic dividend, and threatens territorial integrity due to the possibility of secessionism tendencies, supra-state regionalism, etc.

Way Forward

- There should be a sensitization program that focuses on India's Obsession with a particular race,
- Charismatic personalities should come forward to voice against the practice of racism,

- Police seeds to be trained, sensitized wrt racial attacks
- Educational institutions need to be more accommodative and inclusive,
- Holding workshops by the govt or civil society to sensitize locals about the culture of racial minorities
- Different agencies of socialization should inculcate neutral values, and compassion, towards racial minorities.

Bezbaruah Committee Recommendations:

- Stringent laws are the need of the hour
- Establishment of fast track courts for speedy disposal of cases
- An educational intervention to bring about change in the attitude wrt minorities.
- Making use of social media to create awareness in the society
- Provide legal awareness to racial minorities wrt a grievance redressal mechanism
- Bonding power over sports should be explored.
- Confidence-building measures should be taken to assure racial minorities about their security and well-being in India.

Question - In the backdrop of growing incidences of racial intolerance briefly discuss its implication in the context of Indian society? (10 marks)

Secularism and Communalism

Secularism:

- **The concept of secularism** = is defined as the principle of separation of govt institutions and people who have the mandate to represent the state from religious institutions and dignitaries,
- Devoid of both inter and intra-religious domination
- Promote equality and freedom both within religion and between religions.
- **Models of Secularism =**
-

US	France	India
The concept was given by Thomas Jefferson	Laicite	---
The state shall not adopt any religion as the state religion,	Strict separation of state and religion	The Wall of separation is porous

The sphere of politics is separate from the sphere of religion, No one shall be discriminated against on the basis of religion he/she practices	Although the state doesn't support any religion neither does it discourage any provided religion is not interfering with the state or other citizen's rights	Religion can never interfere in politics, however, politics can interfere in religion to give effect to progressive voices within the religion and to disagree with certain aspects of it, for eg. Abolition of untouchability, and triple talaq. Etc. Principled distance
Rationale - It is based on the rationale that religion constitutes a private affair hence it will not be a matter of state policy or intervention	Rationale - The church was dominating, so to curtail the authority of the church, domesticate religion, Secularization	Rationale - India has multiple religious groups. Although its idea was inspired by western origin it is rooted in India's unique socio-historic circumstances for eg. the Freedom struggle which advocated equal respect for all religions.
Rights - it interprets equality and liberty wrt individual little scope for community-based rights	--	Rights - it deals with both individual and community-specific Rights
Scope - it has no scope for state-supported religious reforms	Scope - Any overt practice or expression of religious beliefs/symbols is forbidden in the public sphere	Scope - it is compatible with the idea of state-supported religious reforms

- **Principled Distance** = allows the state to be distant from all religions so that it can intervene or abstain from intervention depending upon what is preferred to promote liberty, equality, and justice.

Question - How Indian Model of secularism is different from that of the west. Discuss? (10 marks)

Communalism:

- The origins of **communalism** can be traced back to history, particularly the **British Raj**. After the Revolt of 1857, the British started to follow the '**divide and rule**' policy consciously and deliberately. The antagonistic feelings got strengthened during their rule and ultimately led to the **partition of British India** on the basis of **religious identity**. This did not steam out post- independence, and time and again we witness communal clashes in various parts of the country.
- In English, the word "**communal**" means something related to a community or collectivity as different from an individual. In common parlance, the word 'communalism' refers to aggressive chauvinism based on religious identity.
- **Chauvinism** is an attitude that sees one's own group as the only **legitimate or worthy group**, with other groups seen as inferior, illegitimate and to be opposed. In South Asia, communalism refers to an aggressive political ideology tied to religion. In the Indian context, is most commonly perceived as a phenomenon of religious differences between groups that often lead to tension, and even rioting between them. In its not so violent manifestation, communalism amounts to discrimination against a religious group in matters such as employment or education.
- Communal conflicts usually don't start solely because of religion. In India, communalism happens when religion becomes a way to show differences in social and economic status between communities. It's used as a tool to demand special treatment or advantages.

Elements of Communalism: Communalism or communal ideology consists of three basic elements or stages: Mild Communalism, Moderate Communalism and Extreme Communalism.

Mild Communalism:

- It is the belief that people who follow the same religion have common secular interests i.e., common political, social and cultural interests.
- For example, nobles of different communities (Hindustani, Turani, Afghan, Irani etc.) co- existed (largely) peacefully in the courts of the Mughal kings.

Moderate Communalism:

- In a multi-religious society like India, the secular interests of followers of one religion are dissimilar and divergent from the interests of the followers of another religion.
- For example, the Muslim League was initially founded upon the realization of such differences in interests.

Extreme Communalism:

- Interests of different religious communities are seen to be mutually incompatible, antagonistic and hostile.

- For example, groups advocating partition of the country as the only solution for safeguarding the interests of the religious communities.

Features of communalism

- Communalism is mostly about politics and not solely about religion. Even though communalists are very involved with religion, there isn't always a direct connection between someone's personal faith and their communal beliefs.
- A person who is communal may or may not be very religious, and someone who is deeply religious might or might not have communal beliefs.
- Communalists share a belief in a political identity tied to religion. The crucial thing is how they view people with different identities, particularly those based on other religions.
- Communalism holds that religious identity is more important than things like poverty, jobs, social class, or political opinions.
- It is a multifaceted process based on orthodoxy and intolerance.
- It also propagates intense dislike for other religions
- It stands for the elimination of other religions and its values.
- It adopts extremist tactics including use of violence against other people.
- For example, the ISIS blasted and brought down the famous Bamiyan temple, the last remnant of the Gandhara style architecture.

Analysis: Communalism revolves around religious or ethnic identities, with individuals identifying strongly with their respective communities. Communalism is frequently exploited for political gain, with leaders manipulating communal sentiments to garner support. There is exploitation of historical grievance, perceived injustice and socio-economic disparities with marginalized communities often being more susceptible to communal propaganda.

Types of Communalism

1. **Assimilationist Communalism**
2. **Welfarist Communalism**
3. **Retreatist Communalism**
4. **Retaliatory Communalism**
5. **Separatist Communalism**
6. **Secessionist Communalism**

Assimilationist Communalism:- When a larger religious community tries to assimilate the smaller ones such that the latter's culture gets subdued. For example, Tribals were considered as backward Hindus by GS Ghure (Father of Indian Sociology).

Welfarist Communalism:- Working for the welfare of one's own community. Example- establishing hostels, scholarships, employment opportunities etc.

Retreatist Communalism:- The members of the Bahai community (Bahaism religion) proscribe/ forbid their members from participating in political processes as it is based on the ideology of unity of God, religion, mankind etc.

Retaliatory Communalism:- Communities have relatively hostile interests and often it is manifested in the form of communal violence.

Separatist Communalism:- The demand for autonomy based on religion, however, within the Indian union. Example- the demand for Punjab state.

Secessionist communalism:- Demand for a separate nation based on religion. Example- the demands for Khalistan, Azad Kashmir.

Factors contributed to the emergence of communalism

- **Colonial policies:** The British employed a policy of divide and rule, exacerbating religious differences to maintain control. Eg: Communal Electorate.
- **Socio-economic disparities:** Economic competition and social hierarchy aggravated communal tensions especially in times of economic downturns. **Mappila Rebellion**, the first so-called communal clash, was more of a proletarian strike against the landed gentry than a communal riot. It only so happened that the landed gentry were Hindus and the peasants were Muslims. Such factors culminated in separate electorates for Muslims, which was later extended to the Sikhs and Anglo Indians. Socio Economic disparity has also been systematically documented even in 2006 report by the **Sachar Committee**. These vulnerabilities and unfortunate realities are commonly misused to fan communalism and attain political ends.
- **Partition trauma:** The violence and displacement during partition left lasting scars, fostering mistrust and animosity .
- **Politicization of religion:** Communal parties emerged, exploiting religious identities for political gain, leading to communal riots and tensions. **Eg: Mandir-Masjid politics**
- **Spread of religious extremism:** Social polarization fueled by misinformation and propaganda via social media. Eg: Hate speech and divisive rhetoric via social media can incite fear, mistrust, and hatred among communities, leading to communal violence and discord.

Consequences of Communal Violence

- Communal voting is prevalent in India, where people tend to vote based on their community affiliation.
- Elected representatives tend to prioritize the interests of their community, often at the expense of national interests.
- This phenomenon poses a threat to the progress of democracy and the core constitutional values of secularism and religious tolerance.
- Communal activities create division in society and promote feelings of hatred towards other communities.

- This, in turn, harms the country's human resource and economy, acting as a barrier to national development.
- Foreign investment is deterred by the high level of communalism, leading to caution and potential investment loss.
- Unproductive activities divert labor from productive activities, and communal ideologies may lead to the destruction of public property.
- Violence against any particular community can cause a mass exodus, stampede, and loss of life, as seen in the case of Bangalore in 2012.
- The poor are the real sufferers in such situations, losing their homes, livelihoods, and loved ones, which violates their human rights.
- Children are often left orphaned, further exacerbating the impact of communal violence.

Measures to tackle Communalism-

- Eradicating the problems of poverty, unemployment, and illiteracy
- Value based education without any ideological coloration
- Value of peace, nonviolence, cooperation, and development of scientific temper needs to be instilled
- Reform in the criminal justice system, speedy trials, adequate compensation, increased representation of minorities in law enforcement agencies, training of forces in human rights
- Codified guidelines for administration, a specialized training module for police to handle communal riots
- Establishment of hotlines with respect to complains in the context of communal conflicts
- Setting up of peace communities, responsible and restraint journalism, extremist communal outfits should be immediately targeted and their capacity to disrupt law and order must be crippled
- Active participation of NGOs and civil society to drive away the mistrust between different communities
- Cultural platforms should try to promote peace and harmony between different groups

Efforts Taken:

- **Constitutional provisions:** The Indian Constitution enshrines secularism and equality, providing a framework for a pluralistic society.
- **Legal mechanisms:** Laws have been enacted to prevent hate speech, promote communal harmony, and punish those inciting violence on religious grounds.
- **Social initiatives:** Civil society organizations and initiatives promote inter-faith dialogue, cultural exchange, and communal harmony to bridge religious divides and foster understanding.

Ethno-Nationalism:

- **Ethnic Group** = is defined as a social group consisting of people united by ties of common history, ancestry, common culture, etc.
- People of an ethnic group have awareness of their similarities and how they are distinct from others which leads to the development of Ethnic identity, differential access to resources based on ethnic identity which leads to ethnic stratification and Ethnic antagonism leads to Ethno-nationalism.
- **According to Ericson** Ethnic groups are defined as those who consider themselves culturally distinct and such groups may exist in hierarchical order in society.
- **Sanjib Baruah wrote in India against itself Assam and its politics of nationalism-** he discussed the reasons for the emergence of demand for BODOLAND. - The increased presence of Bengali youth in govt jobs, Illegal migration from Bangladesh (displacement of traditional agriculture workers), Outnumbering of native tribes in the electoral rolls by outsiders.

Unity in Diversity:

- **Meaning of Unity** = a sense of oneness that binds people together on the basis of uniformity and differences.
- **Bonds of Unity in India** - Geographical, regional, socio-cultural, Miscellaneous,
- **Geographical** = the first bond of unity is found in geopolitical integration, India is known for its geographical unity with the Himalayas in the north and Ocean on the side, amidst this Geographical unity we stand politically united, for eg .single constitution, single citizenship, all of us are governed by same political culture.
- Temple Culture plays a significant part in promoting interaction and cultural affinity among people, living in different parts of India, hence it is a source of unity which is reflected in the network of sacred places and shrines
- **Regional Bond of Unity** = Horizontal bond of unity based on caste, and vertical unity on the bases of a common language
- **Cultural Bond of Unity** = Teaching of the religious scriptures, earning religious merits by visiting religious shrines
- **Language** = amidst linguistic diversity Hindi and English (Hinglish) act as a unifying thread, and even Sanskrit also acts as a bridge language.
- **Miscellaneous Examples** = Festivals, Cuisines, cinema, All India Services, Educational Institutions, workplace, defense forces, tourism, patriotism, parliament, social media, nationalism, art forms, etc.
- Diversity in Unity = eg. Patriarchy, marriage, patriotism, etc.

Globalization and its impact on Indian Society:

Definition:

It is defined as a process by which the national and regional economies, society, and culture get globally interconnected through the movement of goods, people, technology, ideas, etc.

Institutions:

- Joint family.
- Caste system.

Sections:

- Youth
- Old age.

Culture:

1. **Homogenization:** Uniformity can also be used in the context of westernization, Walmarization, nuclear family, multiplex theaters, obsession with Hollywood, cinemas, McDonaldization, jeans culture, and pop and jazz music.
2. **Hybridization:** Globalization (global+local).
 - Hinglish
 - Nuclear family with extended ties.
 - Kurta with jeans.
 - Mother tongue+ Foreign language.
3. **Revival of local culture:**
 - Concept of GI Tags.
 - Religious revivalism. (Proliferation of godmen)
 - Revival of the traditional medicinal system (AYUSH)
 - Primary education in the mother tongue. (NEP) Demand for Indian fashion products in the Global fashion industry.

Question: Globalization is seen as synonymous with Westernisation, however, it has never been a one-way process. Discuss. (150 words/10 marks).

Impact on the institution of marriage:

- According to the Collins Dictionary of Sociology, marriage is defined as a socially acknowledged and legally ratified union between an adult male and female.
- According to Mazumdar, there are four goals of marriage:
 - Sexual gratification.
 - Transmission of culture.
 - The social mechanism for children.
 - To fulfill the economic needs.
- Age has increased because of more education and job opportunities.
- Aptitude towards marriage: Now marriage has reduced to celebrations, etc.
- Religious significance has declined.

Religion:

- Secularization, because of which social significance has declined.

- Coexistence of religious beliefs with scientific temper.
- Religious revivalism: Proliferation of godmen, communal violence.
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Impact on education:

- The use of technology in education has addressed the problem of 4 A Qs in education:
 - Availability
 - Accessibility
 - Awareness
 - Affordability
- The emergence of secular education education.
- It has created a competition that is needed for a positive revival of the education sector in India.
- It has promoted the acceptance of cultural diversity.
- Cultural homogenization is getting promoted, i.e. glorification of the western education model and undermining of local knowledge.
- Increase pressure on the education system due to the race for survival of the fittest.
- Social exclusion: Due to preference for the English language, privatization, and competitive screening, it has made the education system elitist.
- Lack of value-based education: The purpose of education has been diluted which was to build the character of the individual and now it is to fulfil the demands of market
- Due to performance pressure, the education system has become alienated.

Youth:

- Lifestyle:
 - Over-reliance on technology.
 - Sedentary lifestyle.
 - Lifestyle diseases.
- Education:
 - Awareness, information, opportunities, diversity.
- Employment:
 - Diverse opportunities w.r.t. Well-paying highlight skilled jobs.
- Value system:
 - Become secular w.r.t. marriage, commensalism, and accommodation.
- The disintegration of joint family.
 - Lack of agency of social control.
 - Lack of agency of primary socialization.